Fall 2012

The Mountainside

Coolfont Mountainside Association

Volume XI Issue 1

The Island

By Jackson Bain

For a moment, think of the Coolfont Mountainside as an island. If we were separated from Cold Run Valley Road, Berkeley Springs and the rest of Morgan County by a wide stretch of water, many things would be different. Our connection to sources of friends, food, fuel, power, communication and other necessities might be much more challenging, and life would be far different.



However, many things would be the same. We would still require a community organization to make decisions about the future self-sufficiency and quality of life, and we would need our neighbors to take part in keeping the community running and safe. We would still share the responsibility for the way things are here today, and the way we want them to be tomorrow.

We all face a common dilemma: as you know, we run our own water system, sewer system, and roads system. There are no municipal organizations that keep them running. A failure in any one of those three pieces of our infrastructure would shut this community down, and deeply affect your investment's value. A very small number of CMA owners work tirelessly as volunteers to keep those critical segments of our infrastructure working. We are completely and dangerously dependent on their fund of knowledge, as well as their continued well-being.

As I step down from my second "season" on the Coolfont board, I would like you to consider some current realities this community faces and some paths to future resolution of some of our oldest problems.

1) We are on our own.

There is no indication of a change in the dormant plan for Freeman Development.

2) Despite—or because of—the continued economic situation in this area, we must do all we can to keep our community looking good, as

(continued on page 2)

Annual Meeting and Dinner

By Lois Copeland

On a cold Saturday, morning, October 13th, dour Annual meeting met in the Barn. Bolstered by heating generators set up by Craig Deane and hot coffee and tea and munchies provided by Hallie Kerr, CMA residents got down to business. Issues included the need to continue upgrading our infrastrure and the cost that this upgrading will entail.

We bid farewell to our board members Jackson Bain and Jean Cohen and thank them for their hours of service for CMA. We welcome on board Anne Beckledy and Dan Keary.

Our Annual Dinner was held at Park and Dine in Hancock. Chef Jeff, formally from Temptations, served a delicious dinner lauded by all who attended. Thank you to Hallie Kerr and Bob and Jean Cohen for planning this fun evening.

December Events

Saturday December 8

*Board Meeting, 10 am, pool office

*Potluck Dinner, 6:30 pm

Home of Andy and Joanie Zuckerman, 417 Salmon Lane, T-6, Wedgewoods

Table of Contents

The Island.....1

Annual Meeting & Dinner.1

Unwanted Neighbor.....2

Reminder from DACC.....2

Bears & Our Trash Bins...3

Ice House Renovations.....3

TV on the Mountainside.4,5

Recipe Corner.....6

Summer Parties.....6

Welcome New Neighbors..6



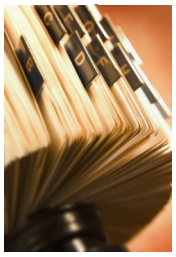
Fall on the Mountainside.

The Island

being safe and being valued as real estate investments.

3) We must educate each other on how to run the community, to spread the knowledge of how the infrastructure works and is maintained to support us all.

The last point may be the most important. To support the limited numbers of resident Expert Members, and prepare for future volunteers, we will soon be creating what I call the "Coolfont Mountainside Owners' Manuel", to be available online, on CD and in the CMA offices in hard copy format. If we gather the content thoroughly, organize it into comprehensible and logical sections, write it so it is clear to even novices in step-by-step format, this document will be our critical backstop if one of our current Expert Members in any one field is no longer available to perform that function.



The manual will be a book with binders for water system, sewer system, road maintenance, financial and accounting systems, DACC responsibilities and forms, public safety protocols and even electrical power line maps. It will provide a system for accurate record keeping, to assemble data to meet our numerous reporting requirements with government agencies that regulate our water, sewer and financial operations. And for future volunteers, it will be updated with each change in hardware, software or policy.

I want anyone in this community who would like to contribute to this project to send me an email at Jackson@bainpr.com. We must get started soon. Our CMA "island" may be on its own, but we celebrate, nurture and grow our community by working for each other's best interests.



Unwanted Neighbor

By Craig Deane

We have a new, unwanted neighbor here on the Mountainside. It is the EAB, or Emerald Ash Bore. The bore is a native of Asia and arrived in the U.S. in solid wood packing material in Michigan in 2002; first seen in West Virginia in 2007 and in Morgan County in 2009. it is estimated that this destructive insect has killed 25 million ash trees in North America.

The adult borer flies to ash from mid-May to September, lays eggs which hatch to larvae that feed under the bark and kill the trees. The EAB kills ash trees within 3-5 years of infestation.

Chemical controls are very expensive and are only recommended for high value trees. The West Virginia Division of Forestry has released some parasitic wasps on the south end of the Mountainside which are helping.

But at any rate, I expect that we will lose about 30% of the trees around my house because the woods at my home are mostly ash.

For more information, there is a great website at emeraldashborer.info.



Ash tree leaves



Mature bark



Seeds on female tree



Emerald Ash Bore

A Reminder From DACC

By Flo Merola

The quest for peace and quiet has always been the reason we chose to make our homes on the Coolfont Mountainside. Construction work, including but not limited to, framing and concrete pouring, roofing, hammering, and the operation of chain saws is permitted from 7:30 a.m. to 5 p.m. Monday through Friday ONLY. Only construction work of a quiet nature is permitted at other times. Please be a good neighbor by complying with this simple rule.

<u>Tree Removal</u>

Owners may remove top or trim trees located within 10 feet of their house without approval, however no other trees over 6 inches in diameter may be cut, topped or trimmed on any lot or on any common property withoutn DACC approval. I will review all requests to remove any dead, damaged, diseased trees or any trees that may lean toward your home very promptly. Please don't hesitate to contact me if you have any questions.



Preserve the peaceful beauty of the Mountainside.

Bears and Our Trash Bins

By the spring of 2011, it was becoming clear those of us in the Coolfont Mountainside community were experiencing an increasing presence of bears in our neighborhoods. Trash bins were being damaged far more frequently, trash bags were routinely being torn apart with trash spread in yards, on the roadways and even onour trails and in our ditches, and methods of trash disposal that had served us well up to now were no longer found to be effective. Over the past year and a half, we have been forced to re-visit how things are done in our community in regards to the not always pleasant topic of trash disposal. In that year and a half, we have not only come to an understanding of why there has been an increase of bears in the community (changing weather patterns resulting in a reduction of natural sources of food), but we have also arrived at some solutions that seem to be working. Whether it be the home owners working with the rental agents in support of more frequent trash pick-ups or the community members refurbishing (with the addition of a latch and post), replacing or even removing their bins if no longer in use, there appears to be a marked improvement in our community even as other communities continue to experience greater challenges. In addition, those homeowners who have opted not to remove bins which are in use are responding by nailing or screwing shut their bins, thus reducing the risk of illegal dumping.

Looking at a few numbers gives us some sense of how things are progressing: As of today, a little over 80% of the homeowners have responded to the challenge by doing the work needed to bring their trash bins into compliance with the new trash policy posted on August 25, 2012. For the months of April, May, June and July of this year, we have had 40 documented incidents of bears causing some level of damage to our trash bins (in many cases with trash spread) and of those 40 incidents some trash bins experienced repeated "hits." Since August 1, 2012, we have experienced a total of 16 incidents, with the bear season anticipated to conclude by the end of October.

I would like to extend a sincere thanks to all the homeowners who have responded to the challenge brought on by the bears in our community by making a real effort to contribute to the solution. It has made a difference.

Addendum

Since this article was written there have been at least 3-4 incidents of our bear attacking trash bins and in one instance tore down a TV dish from a tree.



This trash bin was knocked down the hill.



Seems like a frustrated bear tore down the TV dish

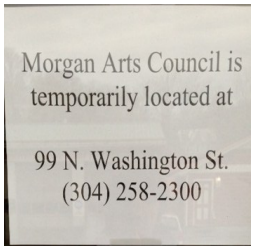
Ice House Renovations Slated to Begin in December

By Anne Beckley

The Ice House, home of the Morgan Arts Council (MAC) and the Ice House Artist Coop Gallery, will be undergoing renovations to upgrade the facility and add new space starting in December. The new additions will include two new "wet" classrooms that will allow artists to teach classes for adults and children, a new kitchen and office, restroom facilities on the 1st and 2nd floors and a large meeting room space on the 2nd floor. Also an upgraded heating and ventilation system in the theater will provide a comfortable and quiet space for concert and community theater performances.

Even though the facility will be closed temporarily, programming will continue with the popular Arts Integration program that brings artists in residence to the county schools to work with children who might not otherwise be exposed to the arts. The building will reopen in Spring 2013 with the popular Quilt show, and Saturday classes in May focused on fabrics—from "ice dyes" to "sky dyes".

A fundraising campaign is in progress to complete these capital improvements; naming opportunities still available for rooms at the Ice House. US Borax gave the 40,000 square foot facility to MAC in 1996. the vision continues to convert this former cold storage facility for apples into a community center for the arts and culture. The Ice



House has been improved over the years on a ""pay as you go" basis so there is no debt associated with the new improvements. Funding for the current renovations have been through a grant from HUD, the West Virginia Division of Culture and History and individual donations from community members. If you are interested in learning more about the Ice House, making contributions or ways to get involved please contact Anne Beckley, Executive Director, at 304-258-2300.

TV On The Mountainside Revisited

By Joe Van Meter

When we bought our home on the Mountainside we were looking for a weekend getaway from the hustle of the city. A quiet place to build a fire on a Fall or Winter evening; to read a good book; to take a walk in the woods; to sip a drink at the long departed "Squirrel's Nest" lounge while listening to music on a Saturday evening. But then we discovered the wonders of radio and TV reception—or lack thereof here on the Mountainside circa year 2000. Wfe still wanted to occasionally tune into news, catch a movie or watch one of our favorite programs. Initially we schlepped VCR tapes from our Northern VA home or from the long gone VCR rental counter at Clarks. Then we joined the DVD generation, scrapped the VCR and began to frequent the local DVD rental store. Well, that too is long gone, as DVD rental stores have virtually disappeared, having been replaced by the familiar "Red Box" and "Blockbuster" DVD rental machines that we've all probably seen most often located at many large supermarkets. As far as I am aware, Berkeley Springs' only current DVD rental opportunity is located in front of our only local food mart— the Food Lion Store.

I would venture to guess that the majority of CMA's homeowners primary residences are located in large metropolitan areas that are served by satellite, cable or FIOS. The latter two delivery means are not currently particularly economically viable from a business perspective to justify any profit-making enterprise to bear the cost of installing them in the sort of very low density market represented by our community. I would not expect any commercial carrier to bother to bear the sort of dollar outlay that would be required to install either cable or FIOS systems on the Mountainside during my lifetime—unless there is some sort of earth shattering breakthrough (or minor miracle).

Satellite reception on the Mountainside, for the most part, is another sad story that, unfortunately, will not change during any of our lifetimes. Satellite TV reception requires a direct unobstructed line-of-sight path between a receiving antenna (your dish) and your provider's fixed satellite location in the sky. Unfortunately, as many of us have learned the hard way, the combination of hilly terrain and heavy vegetation, particularly during the months of March through November, can totally block that line-of-sight. That makes it almost impossible for the vast majority of CMA homes to use services like Direct TV or Dish here on the Mountainside. And, there isn't a lot that you can do about it. If you are lucky enough to be able to have line-of-sight to one of these satellite constellations, it is comforting, though, to know that Direct TV (for one) offers a steep discount to customers that have multiple homes. Owners of second, third and fourth homes pay as little as $5 to $10 in addition per month for each additional service location. That is a huge discount that you need to check if you are a Direct TV subscriber and you haven't already done so AND, of course, if you have that all important unobstructed line-of-sight.

Until the past 12 to 24 months most of us have been relegated to reading a good book, schlepping a DVD, or catching a movie at the Star Theatre if we wanted to see a good movie; or, out of despondency, tuning into a DC or Baltimore radio station if we wanted to hear the news of the world.

But, a lot has happened during those months to turn things around for us. When Verizon (and now Frontier) finally began to offer DSL ("Broadband" Internet service) to CMA customers on the Mountainside, the promise of a virtual cornucopia of potential services—not just computer-based web surfing—became possible. During the same time frame a veritable explosion of video streaming content providers, and providers of the equipment necessary to deliver that content to "a TV screen near you", have delivered on the promise of Internet-enabled TV.

Perhaps the most popular providers of "content" are Netflix, Amazon Prime, Hulu Plus, Vudu, iTunes, and Blockbuster. Most of the "content" that these particular services provide are movies or recorded cable/network TV shows. (Live TV (like NBC, CBS, ABC, .etc.) is NOT typically streamed, simply because commercial outlets do not want to compromise existing revenue streams.) Some of the streaming sources, like Netflix and Amazon Prime, charge a very low fixed monthly price (currently abut $8 a month—YES, ONLY $8 a month) for "all you can eat" on-demand streaming. So, you can watch 24 by 7 for a very low price of $8, and with no .long term commitment. Others, like Hulu Plus, iTunes, and Vudu use a pay per view model, which can become quite expensive. Every day additional streaming services emerge. Some offer news (Al Jazeera and the BBC, for example), and others offer Prime services. Both are within my modest budget and both offer literally thousands of hours of movies and high quality series TV. Many of the TV series are of European origin (BBC, ITV for example), which in my judgment are so much more sophisticated and interesting than the vast majority of current US TV productions.

So much for content. So, in summary, you can get a lot of value for the vast sum of $8 or $16, if you buy BOTH. And, of course, you will need DSL service from Frontier, if you don't have it already. That and your phone bill will cost you on the order of about $80 a month that you will need to remit to Frontier unless you tack on what the phone company euphemistically calls additional "value added services".

Now, let's turn to the "equipment" requirement to set it all into motion. If you already have a serviceable TV on the Mountainside and prefer to not replace it with one of the new bells-and –whistles laden flat-screen TV's, then you can get away with spend

TV on the Mountainside Revisited

ing less than about $75, and that modest investment will provide you with a plethora of streaming services, to include Netflix and Amazon Prime. Although there are several competing products on the market, I highly recommend that you investigate this lowest cost product by surfing on down to the "Roku" web site (www.roku.com), or if you prefer to touch and feel, you can buy a "Roku Box" at your nearest Best Buy store. And that would be all you require to join the streaming video revolution. If, on the other hand, you are already in the market for a BlueRay DVD player, many manufacturers of these products integrate streaming Internet TV into their offerings. For example, Sony's range of BlueRay players include this capability. Like the older generation of DVD players these newer offerings simply plug into your TV. Connection in your Internet Router is typically either via a cable or via Wi-Fi. So, if you want to continue to use that old CRT TV for streaming Internet services, all you need do is make sure that the TV has component video and audio input jacks (or, on newer TV's, at least one HDMI input jack).

If money is no object, then you can skip to the most elegant solution, which is to simply go buy a new "Internet enabled" flat screen, High Definition (AKA, "HD") TV. Most, if not all, of the newer flat screen TV's integrate the Internet streaming capability, as well as Wi-Fi into the TV itself, thus making an interface device like the "Roku Box" or an outboard Blue Ray player serving as the Internet interface, to be completely unnecessary. Expect to pay anywhere from about $500 to $3.000 (or more) for that new TV, though, depending on screen size, brand, and other bells and whistles. When you look for a new TV don't just look at the picture. Pay attention to which streaming video providers that each particular manufacturer links to its "walled garden" of service. Many link to Netflix, but if you think that a particular mix of streaming services is your cup of tea, then you should make sure that the TV you plan to purchase has a working relationship with your favorites; else, you are in for a deep disappointment.



Roku Box, may be found on the net or Best Buy

Now that I've given you one solution to the Mountainside quandary (of limited TV availability), let's turn to a completely different model that at least one of our Board members (Andy Zuckerman) currently successfully uses to receive TV programming. Andy uses a system call "Slingbox". Slingbox requires a broadband Internet connection (like DSL). However, unlike the systems that I described earlier in this article, Slingbox "mirrors" programming that has been received at a distant location. For example, let's say your primary residence is in Baltimore, and that you have Comcast Cable at that location. Then the Slingbox system enables you to remotely control the Comcast equipment (that is located in Baltimore), and it also transmits that programming via the Internet to your home on the Mountainside, where it is displayed on your TV. Slingbox equipment costs vary, but I believe that there is a one-time cost of around $150 to $300 and no monthly charge. If you are interested in additional information and a demo, you might want to contact Andy.

As a final note, I feel compelled to add a line or two about the emergence of what is called "Internet Radio". A lot of folks in the industry continue to say "Radio is not dead". As a matter of fact, Internet Radio has breathed new life into radio. If you are fed up with the dearth of entertainment value in what is often available on the airwaves, both here on the Mountainside and at your permanent homes, you really need to check into streaming radio. It is conservatively estimated that there are between 20,000 and 40,000 streaming Internet-based radio stations (many of which are also conventional over-the-air outlets) that are located throughout the world. Many, many of them offer superior quality programming that is readily available on your computer, tablet, or via a small stand-alone equipment device that looks very much like a conventional table radio—although programming is not over the air, but is delivered via the Internet. And, unlike Sirius XM, all of the content is entirely free. One of these "radios" will set you back any where between $60 to $200, but is well worth it. Music quality is comparable to MP3, but most ears can't tell much difference between fCD quality and MP3, which has been somewhat filtered and compressed to conserve bandwidth. As I write this article I am sitting in an easy chair in my living room on the Mountainside, happily listening to an all Jazz station located in Paris (France), one of my favorites, that I've connected to my home theater system in order to take advantage of its amplifier and much larger speaker system. News sourced throughout the world (although often in local languages) can also be highly interesting, entertaining, and educational, if not for anything else, providing much different perspectives than we ordinarily hear and see—unlike local pap. Another good example of high quality streaming radio programming is BBC in the UK, which provides about ten different streams, each of which is aligned with a different type of programming. So, if you are interested in ultimate variety and good old radio entertainment, with totally free content from around the world, do a search on Amazon's website for "wireless Internet based radio receiver", buy one and start getting news, sports, music and entertainment from the whole wide world.

Coolfont Mountainside Association

CMA
P.O. Box 418
Berkeley Springs, WV 25411
Arnold Weinberg, President
(H)410-730-4681 (CMA)304-258-9199
marzarn@comcast.com
Lois Copeland, Editor
301-530-1115, 304-258-8127
Loiscopeland52@gmail.com
Website: www.coolfontmountainside.org
Listserv address:
cma-members@googlegroups.com

Our summer parties were very successful, but most unforgettable was our annual Labor Day Pig Roast. Even without power we all had a ball. We thank Shane and Erin, without them our pig roast would not have occurred.





From Our Recipe Corner

Brunch Egg Soufflé

Submitted by Joanie Zuckerman

Cooking for a crowd during the holiday season? Here's a recipe that I have made at a potluck brunch at home. It's a winner (and leftovers are good; about 2 minutes in the microwave)!

10 eggs
1/2 cup flour
1 teaspoon baking powder
1 pint of cottage cheese
1 lb. (2 cups) shredded jack and cheddar cheese
1 tablespoon melted butter
1 small can (7-8 oz.) diced green chilies

Beat the eggs, then add all ingredients except the chilies. Gradually beat in the chilies and pour into a greased 13x9 Pyrex dish. Bake at 350 degrees for 35-45 minutes until lightly golden brown on top. Serve with a side dish of salsa to "spice up" the eggs! Enjoy!



Welcome New Neighbors

By Marlene Weinberg

CMA is delighted to welcome its newest members who have recently settled on two neighboring houses on Bobcat Drive.

Russell Foster and Reid Hoffman are the new owners of Q-2, 451 Bobcat Drive, previously owned by Gat and Susan Caperton. Russ and Reid's primary residence is in Washington, DC where Russ works at the Office of Personnel Management on the background investigation/clearance system and Reid works at the Smithsonian in the Freer and Sackler Galleries. Russ says they rented Star Gazer in Coolfont for Christmas about 4 years ago and like the neighborhood. They looked at Harpers Ferry and Berkeley Springs for a weekend home, probably looking at 40 houses, and fell in love with this house "as soon as we walked through the door". With no plans to rent their new home Russ and Reid hope to get to Coolfont every possible weekend and view it potentially as a full-time retirement home. Q-2 has now been named "A Little R & R."

James (Jamie) Sullivan and Cara Sabolcik are the new owners of Q-3, 487 Bobcat Drive, previously owned by T.K. Lee and Philip Sobutka. Jamie and Cara live in Annapolis where Jamie is a computer engineer at Annapolis Micro Systems, Inc. and Cara is a librarian at St. John's College. Jamie and Cara are avid travelers whose five-continent destinations include St. John USVI (10-15 times), Belize, Barbados, Venezuela, Panama, Costa Rica, Nicaragua, Honduras, the Cook Islands, French Polynesia, the Seychelles, Japan and Spain. Jamie is a semi-professional photographer whose main interest is underwater photography as well as nature photography in general. Cara is an avid reader whose job gives her access to virtually



every book in and out of print. Jamie and Cara had been looking for a place to get away from the city and they absolutely love Berkeley Springs. When they saw this house, they "knew it was the one." They hope to use the house as a weekend getaway, but will rent it out when they are not using it. For now they are retaining the current name "Mountainside Hearth". Joining them on their weekend visits will be their two mutts, while their two cats will gladly stay behind enjoying the peace and quiet.